JAKOB SCHMIDHÄUSER

November 2026

L7 1, 68161 Mannheim, Germany jschmidh@mail.uni-mannheim.de +49 621 1235-186
Jakob Schmidhäuser

Research Fields

Public Economics, Labor Economics, Economics of Science

Education

University of Mannheim, CDSE - PhD in Economics since 09/2020

University of Mannheim - M.Sc. in Economics 2019

University of Heidelberg - B.Sc. in Economics 2017

Working Papers

Foreign Troops, Local Economies: The Economic Effects of US Withdrawals from Germany (JMP)
with Johannes Kochems [Discussion Paper]

This paper analyzes the local economic impacts of troop deployments. We exploit variation from the historic large-scale US troop withdrawal from Germany triggered by the end of the Cold War, to estimate the effect on local labor markets and public finances. We use administrative data provided by the US Department of Defense to quantify the size of the troop withdrawal at the municipal level. Using a synthetic difference-in-differences estimator, we find negative effects on local labor markets: for each withdrawn US soldier, the number of local jobs decreases by 0.53. The decrease in economic activity results in a reduction of revenues which municipalities balance by lowering their expenditures, while increasing business and property tax multipliers. In individual-level analyses, we document that workers displaced by the closure of a US military base have persistently lower employment rates. Moreover, their daily wages remain around 9.2 percent lower fifteen years after the layoff. The negative impact on labor outcomes is particularly pronounced for women, older workers, and those employed in regions with more unfavorable initial labor market conditions.

Media Germany: Handelsblatt (1), (2), (3), DIE ZEIT, Süddeutsche Zeitung, DER SPIEGEL, Frankfurter Allgemeine, DIE WELT, Focus, Stern, ntv, Staatsanzeiger BW, ...

Media International: Bloomberg, The Telegraph, IlSole24Ore

Podcast: ZEW Wirklich Wirtschaft: Spotify, Apple Podcasts

Inequality as a Constraint on (Repugnant) Markets
with Paul Hild [Draft]

When third parties oppose repugnant transactions, legal bans often prevent welfare-improving trades. We provide the first causal evidence that financial inequality between transacting parties drives such opposition. In a pre-registered vignette experiment (N = 1,073), we alter the income levels of buyer and seller across five vignettes describing repugnant transactions. We test the effect in two independent samples (a U.S. sample and a sample drawn from selected European countries) and find that inequality increases willingness to prevent transactions by 21%. The effect goes beyond the effect of low income: opposition rises substantially more when a low-income seller faces a richer buyer than when both parties have equally low incomes. Inequality also affects repugnance norms, suggesting it strengthens the collectively enforced character of repugnance. Moreover, we show that the same market can be contested for opposing reasons depending on the relational context: under equal incomes, high prices increase opposition (coercion); under inequality, low prices increase opposition (exploitation). Our findings suggest that market design addressing socioeconomic asymmetry between parties may reduce resistance to repugnant markets.

Work in Progress

Statistical Significance
with Abel Brodeur and Michaela Slotwinski

Foreign Troops, Local Politics: The Political Effects of US Withdrawals from Germany
with Johannes Kochems

Surviving Mass Layoffs
with Efi Adamopoulou and Alexandre Gnaedinger

Academic Positions

Postdoc (50%) U Freiburg, Institute for Public Finance and Social Policy — since 10/2026
Prof. Kristina Strohmaier
TA Public Finance II (BA)

Researcher (50%) ZEW Mannheim, Inequality and Public Policy — since 10/2026
Head: Prof. Holger Stichnoth

Researcher (100%) ZEW Mannheim, Inequality and Public Policy — 09/2021
Head: Until 05/2022 Prof. Sebastian Siegloch, since 06/2022 Prof. Holger Stichnoth — 09/2026

Teaching Assistant Chair of Public Economics, U Mannheim — since 09/2021
Prof. Eckhard Janeba
Substitute lecturing, thesis corrections, seminar supervision

Teaching Assistant Chair of Econometrics, U Mannheim — 01/2024
Prof. Carsten Trenkler — 06/2024
TA Econometrics (BA)

Research Assistant ZEW Mannheim, Inequality and Public Policy — 10/2017
Prof. Sebastian Siegloch — 09/2019

Intern ZEW Mannheim, International Distributional Analyses — 05/2017
Prof. Andreas Peichl — 07/2017

Research Stays

University of Ottawa (Prof. Abel Brodeur, 03/2025, 1 month) — 2025
University of Cologne (Prof. Sebastian Siegloch, 08/2025, 1 week)

University of Cologne (Prof. Sebastian Siegloch, 10/2024, 1 week) — 2024
University of Basel (Prof. Kurt Schmidheiny, 08/2024, 1 day)
LMU Munich (Prof. Andreas Peichl, 06/2024, 1 week)

University of Cologne (Prof. Sebastian Siegloch, 08/2023, 1 week) — 2023

Seminars, Conferences, Workshops

Public Seminar (U Mannheim), ENGAGE.EU Young Researchers' Workshop (U Mannheim), EEA (Dublin), IIPF (Lisbon), Replication Games (U Freiburg), Leibniz Workshop on Defence Economics (IfW Kiel), Hanns-Martin-Schleyer Workshop (Berlin), Replication Games & Political Economy Replication Workshop (Marburg) — 2026

Internal Seminar (U Ottawa), Applied Lunch Seminar (U Cologne), StBA x ZEW Taxpayer-Panel Workshop (ZEW), Scientific Advisory Board Meeting (ZEW) — 2025

Experimental Seminar (U Mannheim), Bonn-Frankfurt-Mannheim PhD Conference (U Bonn), EU Horizon Workshop (IBS Warsaw), Public Finance Conference (ZEW), IIPF (Prague), Public PhD Workshop (LMU Munich), CRC TR 224 Workshop on Labor Markets IV (U Mannheim), HeiKaMaxY (U Mannheim), Public Seminar (U Mannheim) — 2024

MannheimTaxation Conference (ZEW), GESS Research Day (U MA), Public Seminar (U MA), MannheimTaxation Workshop (ZEW) — 2023

Academic Service

Replication: Replication Games (I4R), Freiburg; replication: Replication Games (I4R), Marburg 2026

Organizer: ZEW Summer Workshop 2025 2025

Funds

€31,799 research grant MannheimTaxation (with Tobias Kreuz) 2026

€40,420 research grant Leibniz ScienceCampus MannheimTaxation (with Michaela Slotwinski) 2022

€20,000 PhD scholarship (16 months) 2020-2021

€5,000 European Exchange Program Scholarship (5 months) 2015-2016

Policy Consulting

Retirement Planning Using the Digital Pension Overview – An Empirical Evaluation ongoing
with Tabea Bucher-Koenen, Mathias Dolls, Holger Stichnoth and Silke Übelmesser
Website

Micro-simulating VAT and Energy Taxes in ZEW-EviSTA Using the EVS ongoing
with Michael Hebsaker and Holger Stichnoth
Website

Horizon Europe, WeLaR: New Forms of Work and Workers' Demand for Security and Stability 2025
with Zuzanna Kowalik, Piotr Lewandowski, Fabrizio Pompei, Wojciech Szymczak and Laurène Thil
Report; press release

Quantification of a Basic Child Allowance 2023
with Maximilian Blömer, Holger Bonin, Hans-Martin von Gaudecker, Michael Hebsaker, Tobias Kreuz, Andreas Peichl, Tamara Ritter, Holger Stichnoth and Christian Zimpelmann
Website; media (selected): DIE ZEIT, Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, DER SPIEGEL, Focus, Berliner Zeitung

Scientific Analyses of Bavarian Family Policies 2022
with Florian Buhlmann, Michael Hebsaker, Tobias Kreuz, Lukas Riedel and Holger Stichnoth
Report; media coverage: Süddeutsche Zeitung; press releases: Green Party, ZEW

Other Publications

Buhlmann, F., Hebsaker, M., Kreuz, T., Schmidhäuser, J., Siegloch, S., & Stichnoth, H. (2022). ZEW-EviSTA: A microsimulation model of the German tax and transfer system. ZEW-Centre for European Economic Research Discussion Paper, (22-026).

Supervisors & Reference

Prof. Eckhard Janeba
janeba@uni-mannheim.de
University of Mannheim

Prof. Sebastian Siegloch
siegloch@wiso.uni-koeln.de
University of Cologne

Prof. Abel Brodeur
abrodeur@uottawa.ca
University of Ottawa